

# The most valuable thing Norus could bring to Hack876 is Norus.

Hack876 will put approximately 80 of Jamaica's young makers in one room and give them a day to turn ideas into working prototypes. For the first one, we would love to put some of Jamaica's working builders beside them.

Kingston, Jamaica · 2027

80

YOUNG BUILDERS

20

TEAMS

1

BUILD DAY



**BRING THE BENCH.**

# Meet Hack876.



Hack876 is a one-day build competition for approximately **80 secondary-school students** from 5th Form through Upper 6th Form, working in teams of 4 to 5, roughly 20 teams in all.

Teams pick a real problem, use modern tools including AI, get guidance from mentors, and finish the day with a working prototype and a pitch to judges. It is not a school assignment and there is no answer key.

Our organized inaugural network is the 9 Kingston schools where Hack876 already has relationships. It is not intended to be exclusive to them.

## Open to eligible students beyond those schools.

Students elsewhere in Jamaica may take part, subject to capacity. In this first year, Hack876 cannot provide transportation, lodging or travel coordination for students coming from farther away. **That is a year-one constraint, not the long-term vision.**

# Real software, by teenagers, against the clock.

Most teams will build something with a screen. Some will wire something up. All of them will have to scope, build, test and demo it by the end of the day.

In other words: the whole software lifecycle, compressed into one very long day.

 A web app

 A mobile app

 An AI tool

 An automation

 A data product

 A tool for a community group

 Hardware

 A physical prototype

```
$ git commit -m "it works on my laptop, demo at 4"
```

# Builder to builder.



Jermaine, Norus is a Jamaican-founded company that builds software for a living: custom web and mobile applications, AI development, UI/UX and website design,<sup>1</sup> run through a process of discovery, design, development and delivery.<sup>4</sup>

Your team spans the people a hackathon needs most: developers from junior to lead, project managers, a head of projects, a web designer, and a CTO and CEO who co-founded the company.<sup>2</sup>

And Norus builds for impact. Its own site describes design, software development and product management support for non-profits, social enterprises and impact-driven startups.<sup>2</sup>

**Hack876 students will spend the day doing a miniature version of what Norus does every week: understand a problem, scope it, design it, build it and ship something people can use.**

# Hack876 is not asking Norus to discover youth tech. You are already in it.

## EARLY CAREER

### Norus Internship Programme

Mentor pairing and comprehensive training to prepare junior developers for professional work.<sup>3</sup>

## HIGH SCHOOL

### JamCoders

Norus is a partner and sponsor of this summer camp teaching algorithms and programming to high-school students, first launched in 2022 at UWI Mona.<sup>3</sup>

## UNIVERSITY

### Norus Technologies Education Grant

Each semester, funds for four computer science students in Jamaica, with mentorship and guidance.<sup>3</sup>

## UNIVERSITY

### Project Calico

Jamaican university students work on open-source projects with an experienced mentor and a stipend for meeting project goals.<sup>3</sup>

## COMMUNITY

### Kingston Beta

Curation of the long-running Caribbean tech community brand was handed over to Norus in 2022.<sup>3</sup>

**You already know what happens when experienced builders sit beside emerging talent.**

# What if Norus met the next great Jamaican software engineer before they had written a university application?

HACK876 SITS HERE

**01**

**Secondary school**

JamCoders (partner and sponsor)

**02**

**University**

Education Grant · Project Calico

**03**

**Internship**

Norus Internship Programme

**04**

**Software engineer**

Teams like Norus

**05**

**Tech leadership**

Kingston Beta and the wider ecosystem

Norus programmes as described on its own site.<sup>3</sup> Taking part in Hack876 does not imply access to any Norus programme, internship, grant or hiring.

**An earlier hello, not a transaction.**

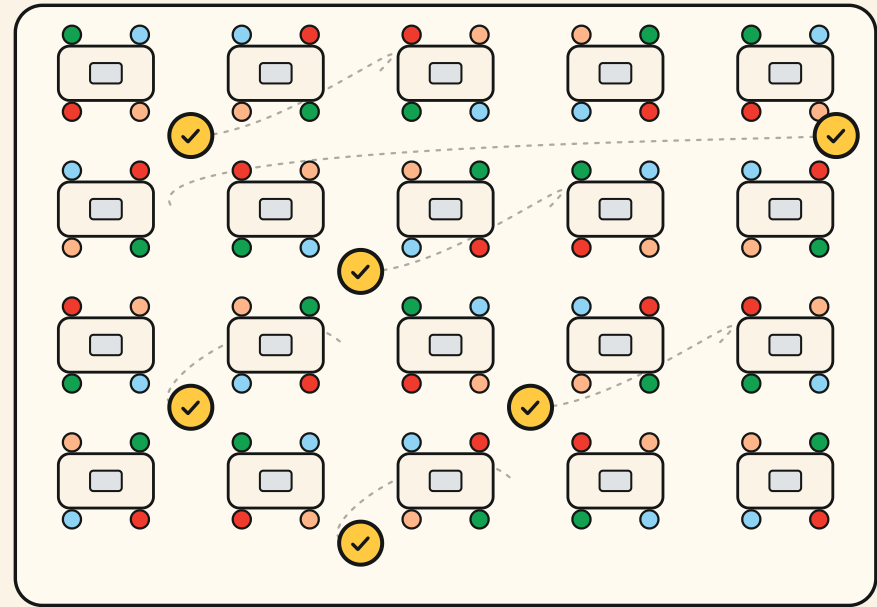
# BRING THE BENCH.

Hack876 can provide the room, the young builders, the problems, the energy and the clock.

**Norus can provide something we cannot: people who build software for a living.**

We would love Norus to bring as many of its team as it can reasonably make available, circulating among the 20 teams through the hacking period.

**Not building the projects for students.  
Helping students get unstuck.**



● 20 teams, and a handful of Norus mentors moving between them.

# Ten small interventions that change a team's whole day.

- 
- |                                                                        |                                                                |                                                                 |                                                                                      |                                                                            |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>01</b> Cutting an impossible scope into something buildable by 4 PM | <b>02</b> Debugging a blocker without taking over the keyboard | <b>03</b> Reasoning through architecture, APIs and integrations | <b>04</b> Reviewing a data model before it becomes a problem                         | <b>05</b> Asking whether a feature is actually necessary                   |
| <b>06</b> UX and product thinking when the screen makes no sense       | <b>07</b> Helping a team recover when its first idea fails     | <b>08</b> Reviewing a demo before the judges see it             | <b>09</b> Telling a student who thinks they are "not technical enough" that they are | <b>10</b> Translating professional habits into language a teenager can use |
- 

Students keep ownership of their work. Mentors guide; teams build.

# Bring as many builders as you reasonably can.

We will put them to work helping the next generation build. Norus does not need to commit its whole team for the whole day.

- ✓ A core group for the whole hacking period
- ✓ Specialists who drop in for set windows
- ✓ Jermaine and senior staff to mentor, judge or speak
- ✓ Rotating team members in shifts
- ✓ Developers who circulate for a few hours
- ✓ Any mix that is operationally realistic

ACROSS 20 TEAMS

**4 mentors**

≈ 5 teams each

**8 mentors**

≈ 2.5 teams each

**12 mentors**

≈ 1.7 teams each

Even a handful of Norus mentors could materially change the day. More is even better.

We do not just want the  
Norus logo in the room.

**WE WANT NORUS IN THE ROOM.**

PROPOSED RECOGNITION

**Norus Technologies**

Mentorship Partner · Inaugural Hack876

- ✓ "Norus Mentor Corps" identification on-site
- ✓ A small Norus mentor help station
- ✓ Recognition on the partner page once confirmed
- ✓ Students knowing exactly who Norus mentors are and where to find them
- ✓ Mentor badges or lanyard designation
- ✓ Recognition in opening and closing remarks
- ✓ Photography and recap content

# Mentors first. Everything else is welcome too.

## Official Prize Partner

**US\$3,400 to US\$3,500**

Underwrite the primary competition prizes.

|                        |                        |                         |
|------------------------|------------------------|-------------------------|
| <b>Hack 876 Winner</b> | 4 × iPad               | Approximately US\$1,800 |
| <b>Second Place</b>    | 4 × AirPods Pro        | Approximately US\$1,000 |
| <b>Third Place</b>     | 4 × US\$150 gift cards | US\$600                 |

### Hack876 Official Prize Partner · Norus Technologies

Exact cost and configuration can move with pricing, availability and final team structure.

## Food & Student Experience Partner

**US\$1,000**

Approximately J\$150,000

Keeping approximately 80 teenagers, and the people supporting them, going through a full build day.

- ✓ Student meals
- ✓ Water and refreshments
- ✓ Light hospitality
- ✓ Snacks
- ✓ Serving supplies

### Hack876 Food & Student Experience Partner · Norus Technologies

# A low-friction yes.

Sponsor one special award for US\$200, or all 3 for US\$600.

Best Design presented by Norus

US\$200

Boldest Idea presented by Norus

US\$200

People's Choice presented by Norus

US\$200

## ELBOW GREASE · A REAL PARTNERSHIP OPTION

**"I can't write a big cheque, but I can give you eight people for the day."**

That is a major win for us.

Mentors

Judges

Technical volunteers

A speaker

Project-management support

UX and design guidance

Day-of tech troubleshooting

Event volunteers

Challenge ideation

Pre-event technical feedback

Tech-community connections

# Mix and match. There is no fixed package.

## OUR PREFERRED COLLABORATION

### Norus Mentor Corps

Contribution: time + expertise

Norus builders circulating among the teams, helping students get unstuck and ship.

#### OFFICIAL PRIZE PARTNER

The primary competition prizes.

**~US\$3,500**

#### FOOD & STUDENT EXPERIENCE

Approximately J\$150,000 for meals and refreshments.

**US\$1,000**

#### ALL SPECIAL AWARDS

Best Design, Boldest Idea, People's Choice.

**US\$600**

#### ONE SPECIAL AWARD

Your pick, presented by Norus.

**US\$200**

#### OTHER IN-KIND / ELBOW GREASE

Expertise, volunteers, connections, resources.

**Time**

#### COMBINATIONS WELCOME

Mentors only

Mentors + one US\$200 award

Mentors + food

Mentors + the full prize pool

A financial contribution without staffing

# There is no faceless sponsorship process here.

Stefen is asking **Jermaine Henry, CoFounder & CEO of Norus**, directly.<sup>2</sup>

We would especially love you in the room yourself, as a judge, mentor, speaker or just someone students get to meet. But Norus taking part does not depend on it.

If Norus is interested, we can decide together what involvement should actually look like.

## QUESTIONS WE WOULD ANSWER TOGETHER

- ✓ How many Norus team members can take part?
- ✓ Who should mentor, and when?
- ✓ Would Norus also like to cover prizes or food?
- ✓ Does one of the special awards fit?
- ✓ Would Jermaine like to judge or speak?
- ✓ Is there a contribution Norus thinks would be more useful?

**A conversation, not a workload.**

# We are building the first one.

Approximately 80 students, 20 teams, a 9-school organized network and one day in Kingston.

Deliberately focused. We will not promise national logistics we cannot deliver yet.

**Build it well.**

**Learn.**

**Earn the right to make it larger.**



# No multi-year commitment required.

**2027**

**Come help these kids ship.**

That is the whole ask.

FUTURE POSSIBILITIES, ONLY IF BOTH SIDES FIND YEAR ONE VALUABLE. NOT COMMITMENTS.

The Norus Mentor Corps returning each year

Pre-event build workshops for teams

Connections for Hack876 alumni into Jamaica's tech community

Mentoring students from beyond Kingston as Hack876 grows

Norus judges on the finals panel



HACK876 × NORUS TECHNOLOGIES

**A student may forget  
whose logo was on the wall.**

**THEY WILL REMEMBER THE ENGINEER  
WHO SAT BESIDE THEM WHEN THEIR  
PROJECT BROKE.**

Hack876 gives young Jamaicans one day to discover what they can build. Jermaine, we would love Norus Technologies to put some of Jamaica's working builders in the room with them.

**That is the invitation.**

**Kingston, Jamaica • 2027**

[hack876.com](https://hack876.com)

#### SOURCES

1. Norus Technologies, "Home:" [norustech.com/](https://norustech.com/)
2. Norus Technologies, "Who We Are:" [norustech.com/who-we-are/](https://norustech.com/who-we-are/)
3. Norus Technologies, "Our Initiatives:" [norustech.com/our-initiatives/](https://norustech.com/our-initiatives/)
4. Norus Technologies, "What We Do:" [norustech.com/what-we-do/](https://norustech.com/what-we-do/)

A private partnership proposal prepared for Jermaine Henry, CoFounder & CEO, Norus Technologies.